

AI BADGE



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EU AI Act: a primer

Most professionals can't name a single category. By the end, you can.

Four risk tiers, one literacy clause, five hygiene checks. Stakes: fines up to 7% of global turnover.



Four tiers.

Two you need cold. Two you should recognise.

UNACCEPTABLE · banned outright

- Social-scoring systems
- By governments. Ranking citizens by behaviour.
- Real-time biometric ID in public
- Plus manipulation of vulnerable groups.

HIGH-RISK · heavy obligations

- CV screeners and hiring tools
- Plus medical triage. Education admissions.
- Critical infrastructure (energy, water)
- Limited-risk and minimal-risk are the lower two tiers.

The Act regulates the use, not the model. Same technology, different use, different obligations.

The AI literacy clause.

The reason this badge exists.

Article 4 · EU AI Act, in force since 2 Feb 2025

Providers and deployers of AI systems shall take measures to ensure, to their best extent, a sufficient level of AI literacy of their staff and other persons dealing with the operation and use of AI

systems on their behalf, taking into account their technical knowledge, experience, education and training and the context the AI systems are to be **used in.**

What it means in practice

- Q1** Who is covered?
- Q2** What's the obligation?
- Q3** What does 'sufficient' mean?
- Q4** When does it apply to me?
- Q5** What if I do nothing?

Apply it to any AI workflow you own. Pass or fail per item.

sample-audit.md · marketing team, ChatGPT for emails

```

---
workflow: marketing-emails-with-chatgpt
risk_tier: minimal
owner: marketing-lead
last_audit: 2026-05-09
---
# Marketing emails with ChatGPT
## Audit

bias:          PASS  - human reviews tone

privacy:       FAIL  - customer data in prompt
consent:       PASS  - opt-in lists only
attribution:   PASS  - human author signed

transparency:  FAIL  - subscribers not told
## Remediation
1. Strip personal data before prompting.
2. Add 'AI-assisted' line to footer.
```

Run this on every workflow:

- **Bias**
Could the model produce systematically worse output for one group?
How would you spot it?
- **Privacy**
What personal or confidential data is in your prompts? Is the tool's data policy compatible?
- **Consent**
Did the people whose data you use, or who receive AI output, agree to that use?
- **Attribution**
Are you crediting AI honestly to readers, clients, regulators? No quiet pass-offs.
- **Transparency**
Do end users know AI is involved? Do they have a way to flag a bad output?
- **One worked audit**
Real workflow in, real pass/fail out. Teaches the discipline more than the principles do.

Where the obligations bite.

One on bias. One on a data leak. Both preventable with the 5-point check.

BIAS · the silent screener

"CV screener trained on historical hires"

The model learns to downrank women because past hires skewed male. Looks fair on paper. Discriminates in practice. High-risk under the Act. Audit obligations apply.

DATA LEAK · the helpful paste

"Employee pastes customer data into ChatGPT"

No malice. Just a Tuesday-morning shortcut. The data is now training material or in logs you don't control. GDPR breach. Article 4 says: train staff before this happens.

Classify. Check. Apply. Document.

Classify

01

What risk tier is this AI use?
Unacceptable, high-risk,
limited, or minimal.
The tier sets the
obligations.

Check

02

Does the use case require
a fundamental rights
impact assessment? If
high-risk, the answer is
yes.

Apply

03

Run the 5-point hygiene
check. Pass or fail per
item.
"Bias, privacy, consent,
attribution, transparency."

Document

04

Keep evidence. Date the
audit. Note remediations.
Audits and procurement
questions will come.

Repeat for every AI workflow your team owns. AI literacy is a practice, not a one-off training.

You now have the regulatory frame.

From here it's practice, not theory.

- **Today** Audit one workflow with the 5-point check.
- **This week** Map every AI use in your team to a risk tier.
- **Next month** Build an AI literacy log. Date your evidence.
- **Beyond** Write a usage policy. Train others. Repeat annually.

